



Create Multi-boot Discs

In this guide we will look at how to pack seven distros into one CD

Everybody likes to use, test and hack with mini distros, but no one likes to burn a separate CD for each since a distro only takes up a small fraction of the CD space. This results in low resource utilisation and increases junk. What if we could keep all the distros on one single CD or even all the distros on one USB drive, and boot the distros directly from there through an interactive menu system? Yes, that's what we are going to do! We are going to pack seven mini distros into one CD/DVD or USB drive that's ready-to-boot, so that we can carry them around and boot any distro anywhere, anytime, and at any place.

This guide is written with primarily a CD/DVD as the target medium, but we will also show you how this can be done with a Flash drive. We will pack PuppyLinux, GeexBox, Slitaz, Goblinx (mini), Austrumi, CDlinux (standard) and DSL into a CD and USB drive.

The whole process is divided into seven phases. Each phase is further sub-divided into

numbered sections. Follow Phase I through to Phase IV; then to make a live CD, follow Phase V. Alternately, to create a live USB drive, follow Phase VI, then continue serially.

At all times keep two terminals open—one as the normal user, and another with super-user privileges. In both the terminals, always remain fixed inside a working directory, the *work_dir*. We will either point directories/files relative to 'word_dir' or in an absolute path. If some source packages are required to be compiled, launch a new terminal in the source directory, carry on the compilation and terminate it.

When you see the '#' symbol beside a command, switch to the root console and execute; and when you see '\$', run it in normal user terminal.

If there are not enough permissions when trying to modify/remove some file, then *chmod* it with the appropriate permissions first.

When describing the USB booting, we will call the USB partition '/dev/sdXy', where 'X' is